



Strathmore University
FACULTY OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY
BACHELOR OF BUSINESS INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY
END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATION
HED 2101: PRINCIPLES OF ETHICS

Date:

Time:

Instruction: ANSWER QUESTION ONE (1) AND ANY OTHER TWO (2) QUESTIONS.

Total marks: 70

Question 1

Article: It was about lack of ethics

url: <http://www.fijitimes.com/story.aspx?id=64909>

Wednesday, June 20, 2007

FIJI has not been able to achieve its full potential over the past 30 years because of a lack of good governance, an absence of ethical leadership and a general lack of ethical standards in the community, says Professor Rajesh Chandra, vice-chancellor of the University of Fiji.

He said if the characteristics had been in our leaders in the past, widespread corruption that resulted in Fiji losing millions of dollars would not have prevailed.

Mr Chandra said economic growth in the past three decades had lagged behind other developing countries.

"For almost 30 years Fiji has not reached full potential for development," he said.

"Fiji's overall growth rate during this period was far behind the more dynamic countries of comparable situations such as Mauritius.

"In 2005 for instance, while Fiji's Gross Domestic Product grew by 0.7 per cent, Mauritius experienced a growth of 4.5 per cent, while Trinidad and Tobago grew by 7 per cent. We have also had four coups in the past 20 years. The fundamental problem that we have faced has been lack of good governance, absence of ethical leadership and a lack of general ethical standards in the community.

"We would not have lost the \$240m we lost in the National Bank of Fiji saga, nor would we have had widespread corruption that seems to prevail in our society, if we had better governance and higher ethical standards."

Mr Chandra said that was why professionals such as lawyers, doctors and teachers should lead by example.

He said these professionals would be able to improve the ethics of the entire country if the various professions had codes which were adopted and widely disseminated.

Questions:

1. How do ethical decisions influence the Fiji economy? (4mks)
2. How can one relate critical thinking with Ethics in the context of solving the problems in Fiji? (4mks)
3. In the above article *It was about lack of Ethics*, which form(type) of ethics is the most dominant and why? (2mks)
4. How can one merge practical morality and theoretical morality as a way to solve many problems in Fiji? (4mks)
5. Ethics is the philosophical science which establishes the moral order of human acts. Within the above article, there are few unethical cases/situations cited. Using at least one example, prove that the action was actually unethical/ immoral. (6mks)
6. Explain, using examples, which type of evils are depicted in the above article and which type of good is undermined. (6mks)
7. Is corruption a voluntary act? (1mk)
8. Apart from the typical example of a merchant throwing his merchandise overboard rather than risk the drowning of the crew, give another example of a voluntary-involuntary act. Explain why it is a voluntary-involuntary act. (3mks)

Total: 30marks

Question 2

Excerpt

Title: Utilitarianism: The Greatest Good for the Greatest Number

Posted by: Terry Hollifield

Date: October 19, 2009

url: <http://whatandwhy.wordpress.com/2009/10/19/utilitarianism-the-greatest-good-for-the-greatest-number/>

Utilitarianism began with the philosophies of Jeremy Bentham (1748-1832) and John Stuart Mill (1806-1873). Utilitarianism gets its name from Bentham's test question, "What is the use of it?" He conceived of the idea when he ran across the words "the greatest happiness of the greatest number" in Joseph Priestly's *Treatise of Government*.

Jeremy Bentham developed his ethical system around the idea of pleasure. He built it on ancient hedonism which pursued physical pleasure and avoided physical pain. According to Bentham, the most moral acts are those which maximize pleasure and minimize pain. This has sometimes been called the "utilitarian calculus." An act would be moral if it brings the greatest amount of pleasure and the least amount of pain.

John Stuart Mill modified this philosophy and developed it apart from Bentham's hedonistic foundation. Mill used the same utilitarian calculus but instead focused on maximizing the general happiness by calculating the greatest good for the greatest number. While Bentham used the calculus in a quantitative sense, Mill used this calculus in a qualitative sense. He believed, for example, that some pleasures were of higher quality than others.

Questions

1. Describe at least three criticisms of utilitarianism as an ideological base to establish an ethical system. (6mks)
2. Explain the role of the intellect and will in the regulation of pleasure and the development of virtue in each of the appetites. (14mks)

Total: 20 marks

Question 3

An act or omission may be wrong only because the law forbids it, for example failure to report income. Remove the law and such failure is no longer wrong. But there are some acts which, though they were never commanded by law, would always be good; and others which, though no law forbade them, would still be wrong.

1. Describe the relationship between eternal law, natural moral law and positive law. (6mks)
2. Using an example from everyday social life, describe some acts which, though never commanded by law, would always be good; and others which, though no law forbade them, would still be wrong and reasons why (use the three issues in determining the morality of the act: the object(act); intention and circumstance). (14mks)

Total: 20 marks

Question 4

Date: 15th June, 1994

John is a Kenyan but has lived in the United States of America for the past five years. He has come back for his summer holidays. He has boarded a matatu. After arriving town (Nairobi) just near Kenya Railways, he informs the matatu conductor that he wants to alight. He does so. Within a few minutes three (3) City Council workers accost him and want to arrest him for alighting at the wrong place. John claims ignorance.

- i. Is the ignorance vincible or invincible ignorance and why? (4mks)
- ii. Describe the state of John's conscience before alighting and after alighting. (4mks)
- iii. In order to act according to right conscience which steps should he take (4mks).
- iv. John is considering the best moral act to perform. Advice him and give reasons why it is the most appropriate moral act (6mks).
- v. The City Council workers harass him and ask for a bribe. They advice him that if he refuses then he will be charged with two charges, alighting where he was not supposed to and illegal dumping of papers in the street. Is this a case where the principle of double effect can be applied and why? (2mks)

Total: 20 marks

Question 5

Title: Roe v Wade

url: <http://www.infoplease.com/ce6/history/A0842237.html>

Roe v. Wade

Roe v. Wade, case decided in 1973 by the U.S. Supreme Court. Along with Doe v. Bolton, this decision legalized abortion in the first trimester of pregnancy. The decision, written by Justice Harry Blackmun and based on the residual right of privacy, struck down dozens of state antiabortion statutes. The decision was based on two cases, that of an unmarried woman from Texas, where abortion was illegal unless the mother's life was at risk, and that of a poor, married mother of three from Georgia, where state law required permission for an abortion from a panel of doctors and hospital officials. While establishing the right to an abortion, this decision gave states the right to intervene in the second and third trimesters of pregnancy to protect the woman and the "potential" life of the unborn child. Denounced by the National Council of Bishops, the decision gave rise to a vocal antiabortion movement that put pressure on the courts and created an anti-Roe litmus test for the judicial appointments of the Reagan and Bush administrations (1981–93). In a 1989 case, Webster v. Reproductive Health Services, the court, while not striking down Roe, limited its scope, permitting states greater latitude in regulating and restricting abortions. Then in 1992, in Planned Parenthood v. Casey, the court reaffirmed the abortion rights granted in Roe v. Wade, while permitting further restrictions.

1. The article lists some virtues and vices. Align at least two virtues and two vices according to the two of the four cardinal virtues and the corresponding vices. (4mks)
2. What are virtues and vices? (2mks)
3. Are the habits mentioned above operational or entitative and why? (2mks)
4. Were the three steps in the formation of the virtue of prudence considered within the above excerpt of Roe v. Wade. (3mks)
5. Using the four issues: Duties to God; Duties to Body; Duties to Soul; Duties to neighbour, critique the verdict given in the above case of Roe v. Wade (8mks)
6. Which type of society is the court trying to redefine and does it have a mandate according to natural moral law? (1mk)

Total: 20 marks